

ALARM BEHAVIOUR

The power of recognising & preventing individual stress behaviour

Alarm is a specific form of (communication) stress: a growing shortfall in your own needs or expectations, which triggers negative behaviour in times of scarcity, pressure or tension. If you recognise which behaviour belongs to which shortfall, you can intervene in a very targeted way — in yourself or in others.

Recognise, acknowledge, address and prevent.



The four steps

1

Recognise

- What ALARM behaviour am I showing?
- Which style or preference does this behaviour belong to?
- Which needs or expectations belong to this style?
- Do I recognise this style or preference in myself?

2

Acknowledge

- I'm showing this negative behaviour, so I have a shortfall.
- Where do I experience a shortfall?
- How do I express that towards others?
- What is my role in a conflict or tension with others?

3

Address

- I am clear about my expectations, needs and shortfall.
- I make up for where I have shortfalls.
- Use the communication style that fits your shortfall.
- Measure your effect and impact very concretely.

4

Prevent

- Know your preferences and communication styles!
- Be aware of your needs and expectations.
- Check in times of tension: where am I falling short?
- Communicate with others about your alarm.

CORE NEED — Challenge

Taking on new things, raising the level of difficulty, stepping outside your comfort zone, staying in motion and stimulated, improving and daring to fail, being brave and proactive

ALARM — *"Directly confronting people"*

STAGE 1

ATTACKING

- Demanding change
- Nagging, exerting strong control
- Judging & blaming

STAGE 2

BREAKING DOWN

- Sarcasm, sharp remarks
- Embittered when nothing changes
- Attacking the other's integrity

STAGE 3

DESTROYING

- Making extreme choices, taking big risks
- Anger and physical violence
- Publicly shaming others

CORE NEED — Appreciation

An eye for what you do and contribute, actions not words, an active contribution from your own responsibility, clarity about task, role or assignment

ALARM — *"Working even harder"*

STAGE 1

PERFECTIONISM

- Demanding and overdemanding; expecting perfection
- Working harder and more routinely
- Over-organizing

STAGE 2

VICTIM BEHAVIOUR

- Feeling undervalued and alone
- "Those who won't listen must feel it"
- Feeling exploited

STAGE 3

ISOLATING

- Depression; rejecting others
- Angry; resentful; blaming
- Lashing out physically

CORE NEED — Safety

Overview, clarity, good agreements, acceptance and being able to be yourself, permission to fail, honesty with each other and a harmonious, constructive environment

ALARM — *"Erasing myself"*

STAGE 1

SELF-SACRIFICING

- Doubting yourself
- Negative statements about yourself: appearance, behaviour, qualities, performance
- Erasing yourself

STAGE 2

DEPRESSION

- Making mistakes, forgetting things
- Doubting yourself, "not being seen"
- Feelings of rejection, not being enough

STAGE 3

SELF-REJECTION

- Total distrust of people
- Fleeing into destructive and addictive behaviour
- Experiencing life as meaningless and worthless

CORE NEED — Affirmation

Knowing, seeing, experiencing and hearing that you're doing well, being together, gaining inspiration and staying curious, compliments and positive feedback

ALARM — “Talking too much and too fast”

STAGE 1

TOO MUCH “BROADCASTING”

- Too much: talking, exaggerating, enthusiasm
- Giving unsolicited advice
- Influencing & manipulating

STAGE 2

DEFENSIVE

- Relying on standard solutions
- Denying, easily hurt: placing blame on others
- Withdrawing, turning your back on the group

STAGE 3

GETTING AWAY

- Backed into a corner
- Fleeing into addictions and fantasy
- Verbal violence

CORE NEED — Support

Support and acceptance from your home situation, private life, team or work, but also practical help in achieving success and reaching goals

ALARM — *"Being demanding of yourself and others"*

STAGE 1

DEMANDING

- Stepping out of the process
- Or... micromanaging
- Setting the bar high for yourself and others

STAGE 2

PLAN ABOVE ALL

- Using people for the plan
- Sidelineing others
- Coming across as hard-hearted and cold

STAGE 3

SHUTTING OUT

- Distrustful, withdrawn
- Shutting out close friends or family
- Addicted to stimulants or extreme sport

CORE NEED — In Balance

Giving and receiving conscious gifts, time to work and time to enjoy, efficiency and quality, investment and return, hospitality and the need for privacy

ALARM — "Becoming uncertain about money, resources or the future"

STAGE 1

RESTRICTING

- Rejecting others whose lives aren't in order
- Relying on money or possessions
- Sabotaging renewal, growth or risk

STAGE 2

CONTROLLING

- Giving with conditions, creating dependency
- Expecting or even demanding favours
- Excessive urge to collect or hoard

STAGE 3

ISOLATING

- Stingy, greedy and self-centred behaviour
- Possessions over relationships
- Shutting out the world, hiding yourself

CORE NEED — Recharging

Space and time to be alone and unwind, diving into your own interests, a calm environment, digging deeper, undivided attention

ALARM — *"Stubbornly clinging to my own views and thoughts"*

STAGE 1

RIGID

- Stubbornly holding onto positions
- Self-important attitude, arrogant
- Feeling uncertain, stupid and incompetent

STAGE 2

SHUTTING OUT

- Rejecting people who think 'differently' than you
- Aversion to superficiality
- Sharply and critically attacking the content

STAGE 3

REJECTING

- Feeling misunderstood, rejected and unloved
- Punishing others by not being there
- Keeping loved ones at a distance, hurting them, shutting them out